

Derrick M. Barry

Tel: 0422 480 610
dezz.barry@proton.me

Melbourne-based graphic designer working
across cultural, education and government
communications, with a focus on visual
identity, publication and information design.

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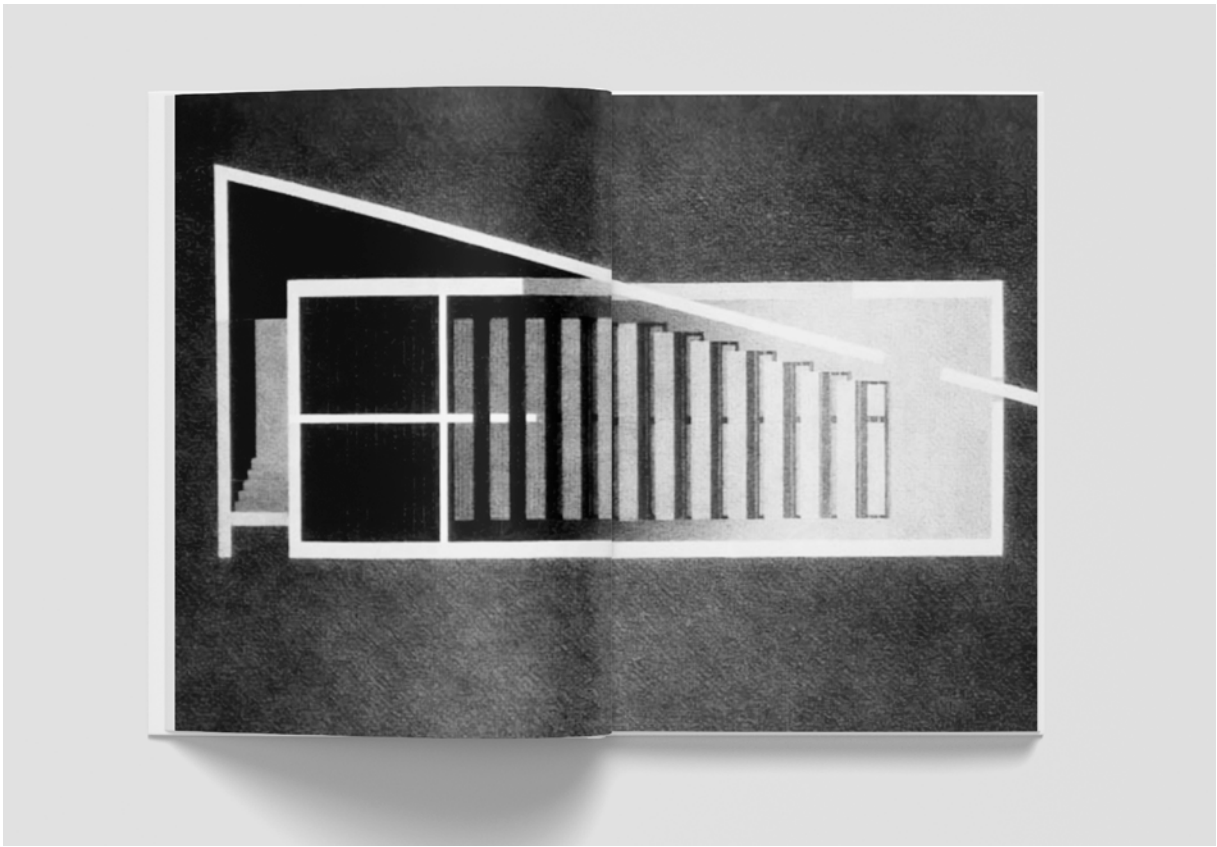
Role: Self-initiated research / design exploration

Ongoing self-directed design study exploring architecture as experience rather than object. Uses publication design as a way to examine ideas of light, shadow, sequence and transformation.

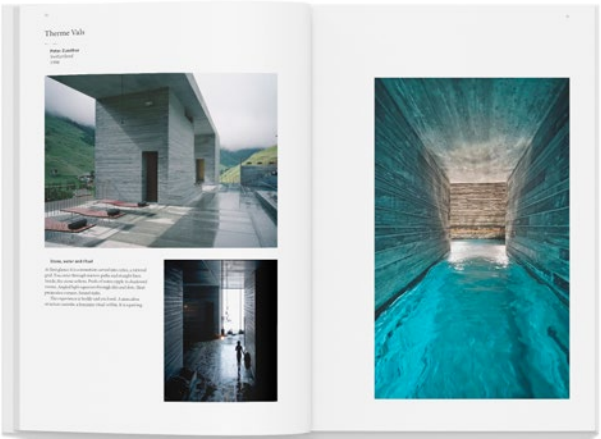
Developed as a research notebook to refine visual judgement, compositional thinking, and narrative pacing, informing later applied work in publication and systems design.

Notes:

- Personal research project, not client work
- Images used for private study and internal reference only
- Focused on exploration rather than delivery







Role: Senior Designer /
Art Direction (end-to-end)

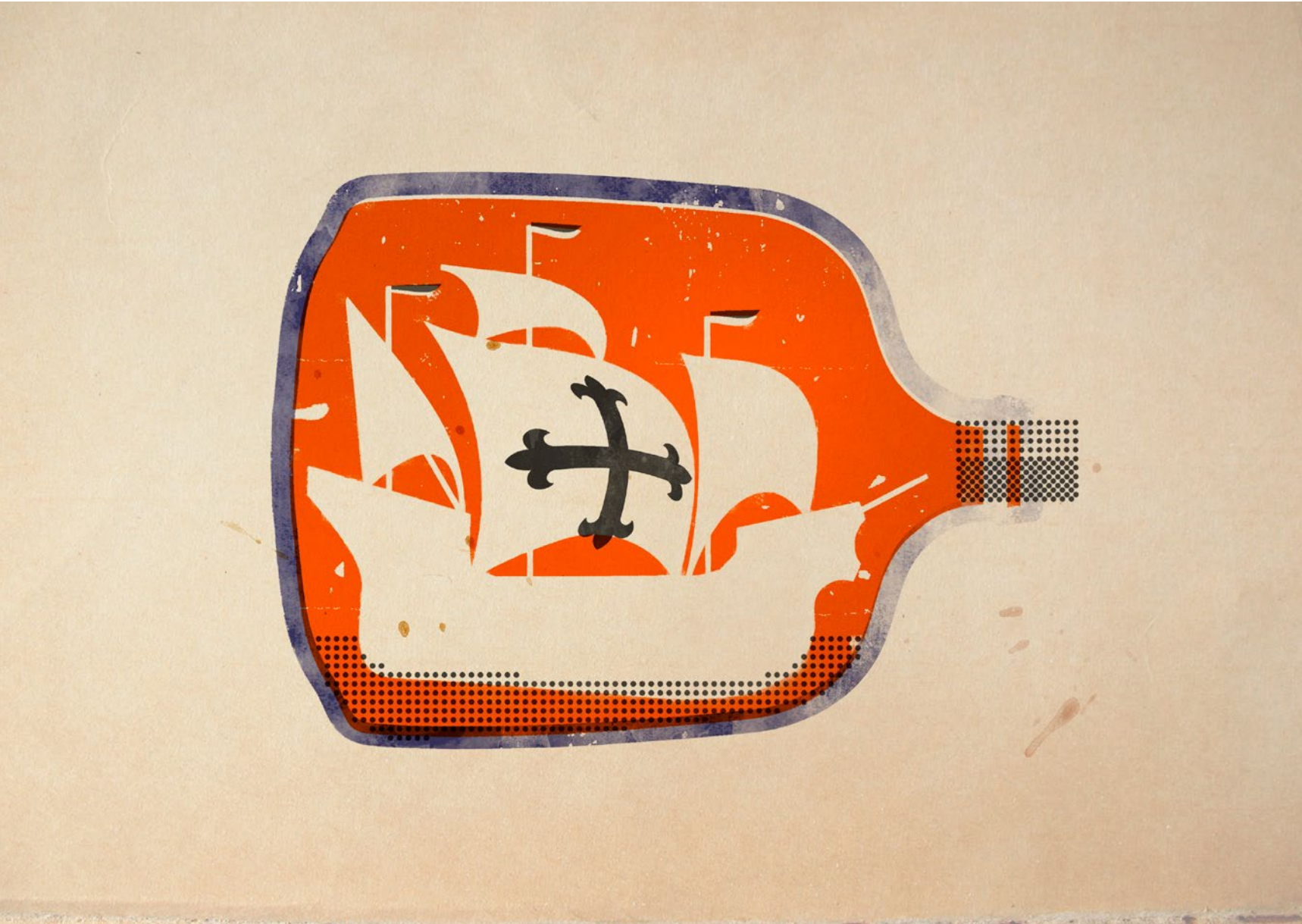
Led concept, design and execution of a compact visual identity system. Developed the “ship-in-a-bottle” mark to reflect meticulous, behind-the-scenes production and the delivery of complex work with clarity and reliability.

Key contributions:

- Established a distinct, professional identity for a solo producer
- Used across digital touchpoints and client communications
- Reinforced positioning around care, accuracy and technical confidence

Outcome:

The identity was designed to function consistently across digital, print and small-format applications, supporting a low-key but highly controlled production model.



Role: Concept Design /
Art Direction

Developed a conceptual visual identity proposal for the Season of Excellence, an annual public-facing event celebrating outstanding student work from across Victoria.

The proposal explored a flexible brand system capable of representing diverse disciplines while maintaining a cohesive and credible public presence.



Role: Senior Designer /
Art Direction (end-to-end)

Worked on a government publication series aimed at making complex design principles accessible to a broad audience, focusing on clarity and consistency.

Led design, art direction and execution across multiple publications. Developed a flexible template and design system that enabled ongoing editions to be produced efficiently by different designers, while maintaining quality and coherence.

Key contributions:

- Translated specialist design knowledge into clear, public-facing publications
- Built a reusable template system to support long-term use
- Reduced production friction and reliance on individual designers
- Supported handover and continuity within a government context

Outcome:

A durable publication template still usable beyond the initial project, balancing accessibility, quality and institutional constraints.



+ Education



Good Design + Heritage



Good Design + Design Review



Good Design + Apartments



Good Design + Transport



Good Design + Design Review 2

Victorian Design Review Panel (VDRP)

The VDRP was established by the OVGGA in 2012 as a service to Government. It provides expert independent peer review of built environment projects.

The VDRP consists of experienced professionals selected through a rigorous process. Architects, urban designers, landscape architects, planners, as well as specialists in sustainability, accessibility, health, place making, heritage, indigenous heritage and masterplanning allow for multidisciplinary input.

What we do

A thorough briefing and presentation of the design response allows the VDRP to provide constructive, well informed advice. Design evaluation of complex projects is multifaceted and multidisciplinary. Issues considered include the project history, site context, budget and timeline. Projects are assessed in terms of functionality, amenity, durability, sustainability, long-term value as well as the conceptual underpinning, aesthetics and materiality. The process is designed to provide advice that helps achieve high standards of design. The OVGGA principles have been established to broadly define good design. They form the basis for design review.

In addition to providing guidance to designers, advice is provided to key decision makers and can include clients, delivery agents and statutory decision makers.

In Victoria, design review is not statutory and it is not measured against a particular policy. Instead, the advice offered relies on the breadth and depth of experience of the panelists.

The expertise of the panel is tailored to each project depending on type, need and stage. Technical specialists supplement the review process if required.

Whichever side of the fence the impact of the Design Review Panel is a better built environment.

Kerstin Thompson
Architect and Victorian Design Review Panel Member

THE VICTORIAN
DESIGN REVIEW PANEL

The VDRP currently consists of 78 highly experienced built environment professionals.

Good Design is:

Design Review is guided by principles which focus on how buildings and places can meet the needs of the people who use them. The OVGGA has defined seven principles against which good design can be judged.

1. Inspiring

Good design embeds the very essence of a project into a narrative and vision.

2. Contextual

Good design is informed by its location and responds to its environmental, social and cultural contexts.

3. Functional

Good design develops synergies between the functional requirements and the project vision delivering value to the end users and broader community beyond primary technical needs.

4. Valuable

Good design enhances the quality of experience, creates stronger connections and supports a vibrant public realm which are all key to realising the full potential for value creation and capture.

5. Sustainable

Good design respects our environment and resources by promoting efficiency, enhancing local ecology and creating a sustainable long-term legacy. Local government should embed specific objectives and targets in every project.

6. Enjoyable

Good design delivers inclusive and enjoyable environments which contribute to broader positive social and economic outcomes.

7. Enduring

Through the synthesis of vision and function, good design embeds lasting value into our built environment.

SWAN STREET BRIDGE, 2018

CLIENT: VicRoads
ARCHITECT: BAK
LANDSCAPE ARCHITECT: McGregor Coxall

VicRoads identified the Swan Street Bridge Upgrade as a significant opportunity to improve the pedestrian and cycling infrastructure, and to enhance the urban design quality of the bridge and its immediate surrounds. The bridge links Melbourne's CBD with the sporting and recreation precincts.

The design was inspired by the movement of rowing cars along the Yarra River, the surrounding architectural language and the existing archways of the Bridge. Design review was used at key milestones using VDRP panel members experienced in design and delivery of public infrastructure. The objective advice helped ensure the design intent was realised through to construction. The advice ranged from strategic public space continuity through to detailed design resolution.
Photographer: John Gollings

Further information

Office of the Victorian Government Architect website provides resources and info that can assist stakeholders in achieving good design outcomes for their communities.
www.ovgga.vic.gov.au/resources

Accessibility

Contact us if you need this information in an accessible format at ovga@ovgga.vic.gov.au

Good Design + Design Review

The Office of the Victorian Government Architect provides leadership and strategic advice to the government about architecture and urban design.

This publication is part of the Office of the Victorian Government Architect's (OVGGA) 'Good Design' series which aims to raise the awareness of good design, its benefits and how to achieve it. This edition looks at the role that Design Review has in improving design outcomes.

Design review is an independent and impartial process that provides advice on the design of buildings, landscapes, public spaces and strategies. It draws on the experience of built environment professionals and specialists. Design review is a free and confidential service offered by the OVGGA and is available to significant projects in Victoria. The format of design review is adapted depending on a project's type, stage and need.

'Design review is a unique forum for a focused and well informed design discussion.'

Jill Garner
Victorian Government Architect

Design review and good design

An important legacy for government is the quality and design of the public projects delivered. Well-designed buildings, infrastructure and public places work well and feel good, promoting community pride, identity and adding a valuable long-term asset to their locale. Design review is an internationally tried and tested process that improves the quality of design outcomes in the built environment. It helps to create better places through critical, impartial, expert peer review. Design review champions the pursuit of the best social, environmental, economic and cultural value in construction. It assists projects to realise their full potential, giving confidence to key decision makers.

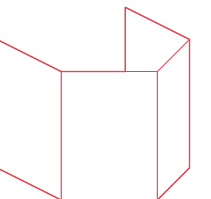
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1. Site Visit - City of Melbourne Bourke Street Precinct
2. Queenscliff Hub, Borough of Queenscliff, KTA
3. Latrobe Regional Hospital, Victorian Department of Health, Billard Leese Partnership
4. 3-5 Shiel Street Community Housing, Community Housing Australia, Clare Cousins Architects
5. Site Visit - Bendigo Creek Masterplan
6. 655 Collins Street Melbourne, Charter Hall, Cox Architecture
7. Design Review - Melbourne Business School, Wood Bagot
8. Bendigo Law Courts, Court Services Victoria, John Wardle Architect
9. Bendigo GovHub, Development Victoria, Lyons Architects
10. St Kilda Pier Redevelopment, Parks Victoria, JCB Architects

— Design Review is a tried and tested process that improves design outcomes.

EFFECTIVE DESIGN QUALITY MECHANISMS

An intersection of three critical commitments is needed to achieve good design outcomes: project-specific design principles, selection of a skilled designer supported by a process of expert peer review.



Reverse

VDRP Projects

Types and Sectors

The VDRP provides design review of projects at key stages of the design and development process. A project does not need to be going badly to benefit from design review. Rather the process adds input and expertise that builds on the skills of the design team and advice provided by stakeholders.

The VDRP is available for review of private and public projects that are of state significance due to their site, context, complexity, or because they establish a precedent for new development in a place. The project may be a civic or public building, have substantial government funding or be part of a departmental program, be innovative in its approach or addresses an emerging city issue.

The OVGA is committed to improved design outcomes for buildings and places used by all Victorians. This means that design review is offered for projects located throughout Victoria.

The VDRP reviews built environment projects of all types and scales including strategies, masterplans, buildings, major infrastructure, streets and public spaces.

Types and process of review

The VDRP can be used in a variety of ways to provide constructive input. The OVGA has adapted the process of design review to cater for the needs of different project types, scales and with various delivery methods. Regardless of the format of review, for it to be successful, it must be carried out using a robust and defensible process. Common features of design review processes include constructive independent advice informed by built environment experts, a deep understanding of projects, thorough briefing with regard for site, budget, planning controls and project scope in a structured discussion.

Principles of design review

Design review processes offered by the OVGA have been refined and adapted from those documented by the UK Commission for Architecture and the Built Environment (CABE), a globally accepted benchmark. All processes are in line with the following principles of design review.

PROJECT TYPES

Since its inception, the VDRP has reviewed a variety of projects from different sectors.

Design Review

Design review by the VDRP offers a process structured to provide effective advice. It involves thorough briefing, presentation by the client and designers, constructive review and summary written advice to the project team. Sessions are held regularly and a dedicated OVGA team works with the project team to guide them through the process. Projects are typically referred by state government or local government and selected based on significance and the ability of the advice to influence the design. Up to 5 panel members, with expertise tailored to the project, attend a VDRP design review session. The design team and client are in attendance to present the scheme and hear the panel's comments directly.

Desktop Review

Desktop reviews are a less structured, conversational form of review. The design team and panel discuss the proposal. It is particularly suited to projects which come to review at a very early stage, for follow-up reviews or at a very late point in the design process.

Principles of design review

Independent
Design review is conducted by people who are unconnected with the scheme's promoters and decision makers, and it ensures the advice is unbiased.

Expert
It is carried out by suitably trained people who are experienced in design and know how to critique constructively. Review is most respected where it is carried out by professional peers of the project designers, because their standing and expertise will be acknowledged.

Multidisciplinary
Combines the different perspectives of architects, urban designers, planners, landscape architects, engineers and other specialist experts to provide a complete, rounded assessment.

Accountable
The Review Panel and its advice must be clearly seen to work for the benefit of the public. This is embedded within the panel's terms of reference.

Transparent
The panel's remit, membership, governance processes and funding is in the public domain.

Proportionate
It is used on projects that are significant to the State or communities.

Timely
It takes place as early as possible in the design process, because this can avoid a great deal of wasted time. It also costs less to make changes at an early stage.

Advisory
A design review panel does not make decisions, but it offers impartial advice for the people who do.

Objective
It appraises schemes according to reasoned, objective criteria rather than the stylistic.

Accessible
Its findings and advice are clearly expressed in terms that design teams, decision makers and clients can all understand and make use of.

Stage and Influence

Design review is most effective early in the design process when ideas are fluid and there is openness and opportunity to take on the advice. Changes can be adapted easily and the value and quality of a design proposal increased, before the cost of changes outweighs the benefits gained. Projects are encouraged to come to review at an early stage, but at key stages or milestones in the design process. However, design review has value throughout the entire project life cycle.

Design Quality Team (DOT)

For large complex ongoing projects or during a competitive selection process, the OVGA can establish a DOT. A multidisciplinary panel of up to four experts chaired by an OVGA representative, provides consistent and timely feedback at key points in the project process. A DOT may have a review role from project inception to delivery and can support stakeholders in ongoing design making about design, including input to value management processes.

Urban Design Advisory Panel

The Urban Design Advisory Panel (UDAP) process was set up to review major transport infrastructure projects including Melbourne Metro, Level Crossing Removals and North East Link. The UDAP facilitates workshops and design advisory processes throughout the project, before major decisions or at project milestones. The UDAP is established to include members with professional expertise in architecture, urban design, strategic planning alongside key project stakeholders and local government representatives. The key focus for the UDAP is to provide collaborative, multidisciplinary, iterative, and consistent advice.

Benefits and outcomes

Design review offers breadth of vision as well as support. The strength of a design review panel's advice lies in its independence, objectivity and ability to analyse a scheme within the context of wider good practice and knowledge. Expert peer review will highlight design strengths, challenge weaknesses and can lead to quicker negotiation of processes that lead to project delivery. Design teams, stakeholders and decision-makers benefit from design review.

Common positive outcomes from design review are:

- Support for and an increase in confidence of decision-makers in delivering high quality, inspiring developments and public spaces that meet the needs of all stakeholders
- Potential saving of time, money and effort by identifying issues at an early stage of the design process
- Support and encouragement of good designs and innovative proposals
- An increase in commitment to improved public amenity
- Effective site analysis informing contextually appropriate design
- Encourage high sustainability ambition
- Support in the recognition of good design outcomes when exercising discretion
- Design quality supported as important in the procurement process.

City Design

Maribyrnong City Council

"The VDRP is supported by members of the OVGA who bring a high level of professionalism in organising and conducting the review process with erudite precision and care. Our objectives were well understood from the initial briefing and the review proved to be a well tailored forum that addressed our key concerns."

PORT OF SALE COMMUNITY HUB, 2017

CLIENT: Wellington Shire Council
ARCHITECT: FJMT
LANDSCAPE ARCHITECT: TCL

The OVGA supported Wellington Shire Council in pursuing a design led process to unlock the inherent qualities of the existing building and repurpose it as a new civic centre to celebrate Sale's status as a cultural centre. This was achieved on a modest budget demonstrating that a great idea does not need to be costly. Design review highlighted the need for a precinct masterplan in integrating the project with the broader cultural precinct. The Council was able to secure funding for landscape works to be delivered alongside the hub.

Photographer: John Gollings

CAULFIELD TO DANDENONG LEVEL CROSSING REMOVAL, 2018

CLIENT: Level Crossing Removal Project (LXRP)
ARCHITECT: Cox Architecture
LANDSCAPE ARCHITECT: Aspect Studios

The Caulfield to Dandenong Level Crossing Removal project replaced nine dangerous rail level crossings with five elevated railway stations along one of Melbourne's busiest transport corridors. By elevating the line and stations, this project presented an opportunity to transform an extensive tract of land within Melbourne's metropolitan zone into a new linear park.

The OVGA provided expert design advice through the whole of project life-cycle, retaining consistent design expertise at all stages of the project including development, procurement and delivery through the LXRP Urban Design Advisory Panel (UDAP) using members of the VDRP.

Photographer: John Gollings

BENDIGO HOSPITAL, 2017

CLIENT: Victorian Department of Health
ARCHITECT: Bates Smart, Silver Thomas Hanley
LANDSCAPE ARCHITECT: Oculus

The Victorian Department of Health used the VDRP to form a Design Quality Team (DOT) to assist in the tender selection process for the \$600 million Bendigo Hospital contract.

The involvement of the DOT in the tender evaluation process through to construction resulted in architecture, civic response and health planning recommendations that were subsequently implemented, resulting in a higher quality design outcome. The planning approvals process was also accelerated.

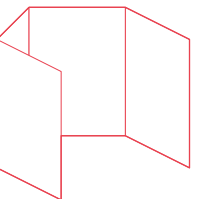
Photographer: Peter Clarke

CLIENT: Department of Environment, Land, Water and Planning CONSULTANTS: REALM Studios

The Siting and Design Guidelines provide best practice advice on the siting and design of structures on the Victorian coast. The VDRP reviewed the document at draft stage providing confidence to stakeholders and recognising the need for buildings in coastal areas to respond to their place.

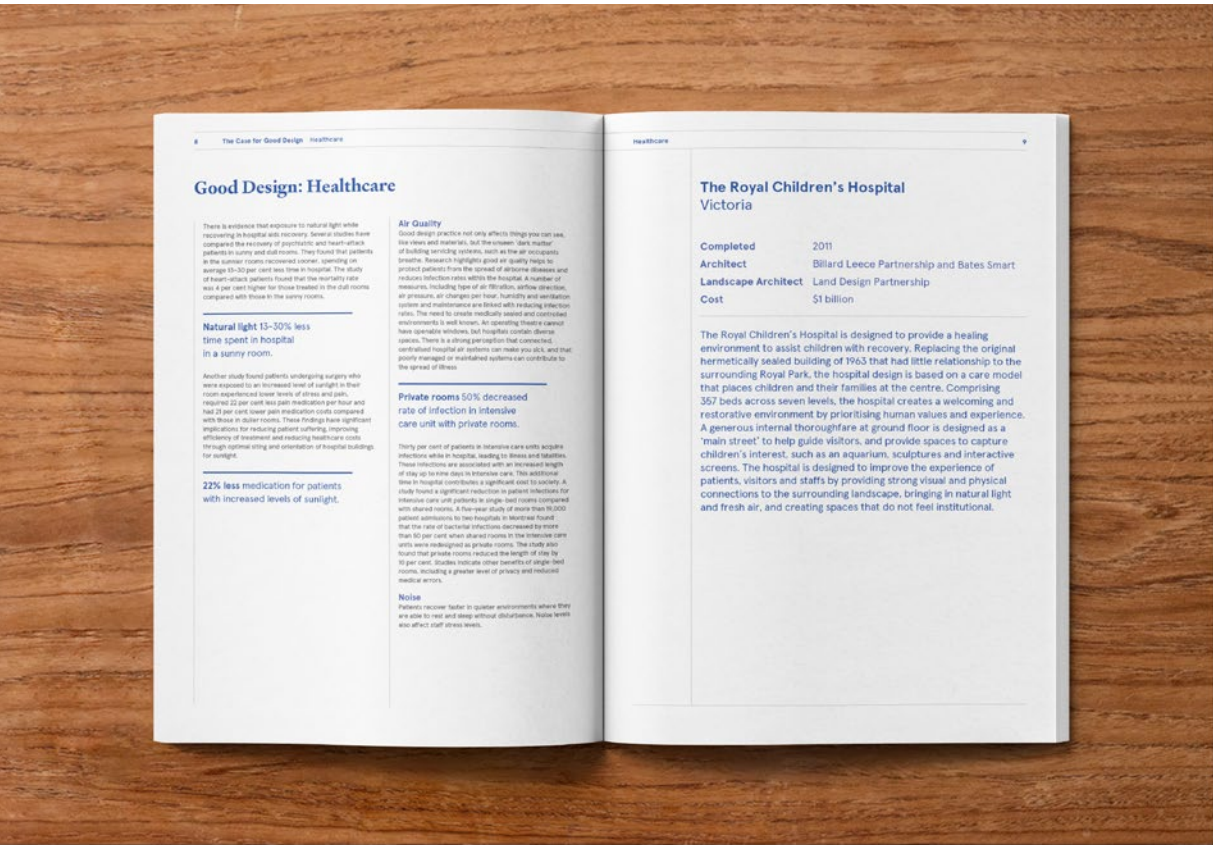
80% of attendees reported significantly improved design outcomes by attending design review.

S&S Report, 2018



Role: Senior Designer /
Art Direction (end-to-end)

A Case for Good Design. An overview of research on how design shapes our surroundings and its impact across healthcare, education, workplaces, justice, housing, urban design and transport.



Role: Senior Designer /
Art Direction (end-to-end)

A full redesign of the VCE examination paper suite, addressing critical shortfalls in accessibility, branding and plain English standards. The project introduced a comprehensive visual system, automation tools and style guidelines — built to scale across more than 100 individual exam papers and adopted as the standard layout for CCAFL language examinations across other Australian states.

One visual system.
Every exam. Every student.

A full redesign followed, introducing automation tools and templates in InDesign to streamline team workflows and embed best practice at every stage.

Layout and editorial proofing standards were established, alongside a comprehensive suite of illustration, technical drawing and map style development.

Alternate format integration was built in from the ground up, ensuring accessibility across the full range of materials.



The Principles

- The decisions were guided by three design principles:
- Clarity** – A clean, easy to navigate layout so students can focus on content, not format.
 - Consistency** – A uniform design across all exams, reducing anxiety and building familiarity.
 - Accessibility** – Accommodating diverse learning needs, ensuring every student can engage with the material without barriers.



The Approach

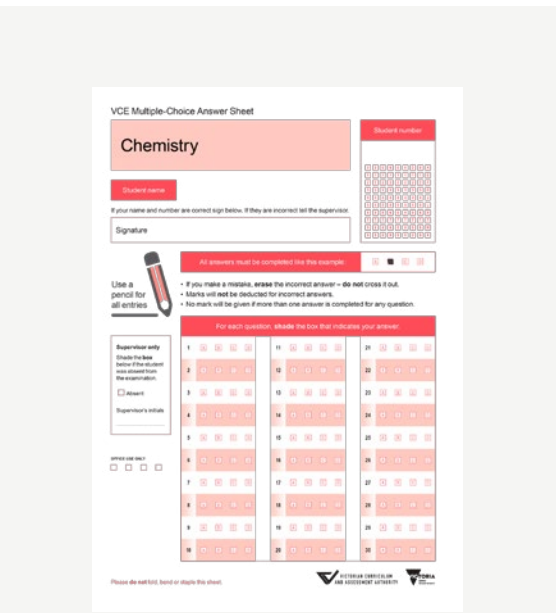
The redesign introduced a considered visual system of cleaner typography, better spacing and a consistent style across all exam papers and answer books, giving students a familiar, intuitive layout so they can focus on answering questions rather than navigating the page.

Key to this was a colour identifier system ensuring clarity and consistency across a series of exam papers, extending to the spine to make corresponding books and sheets immediately recognisable at a glance.

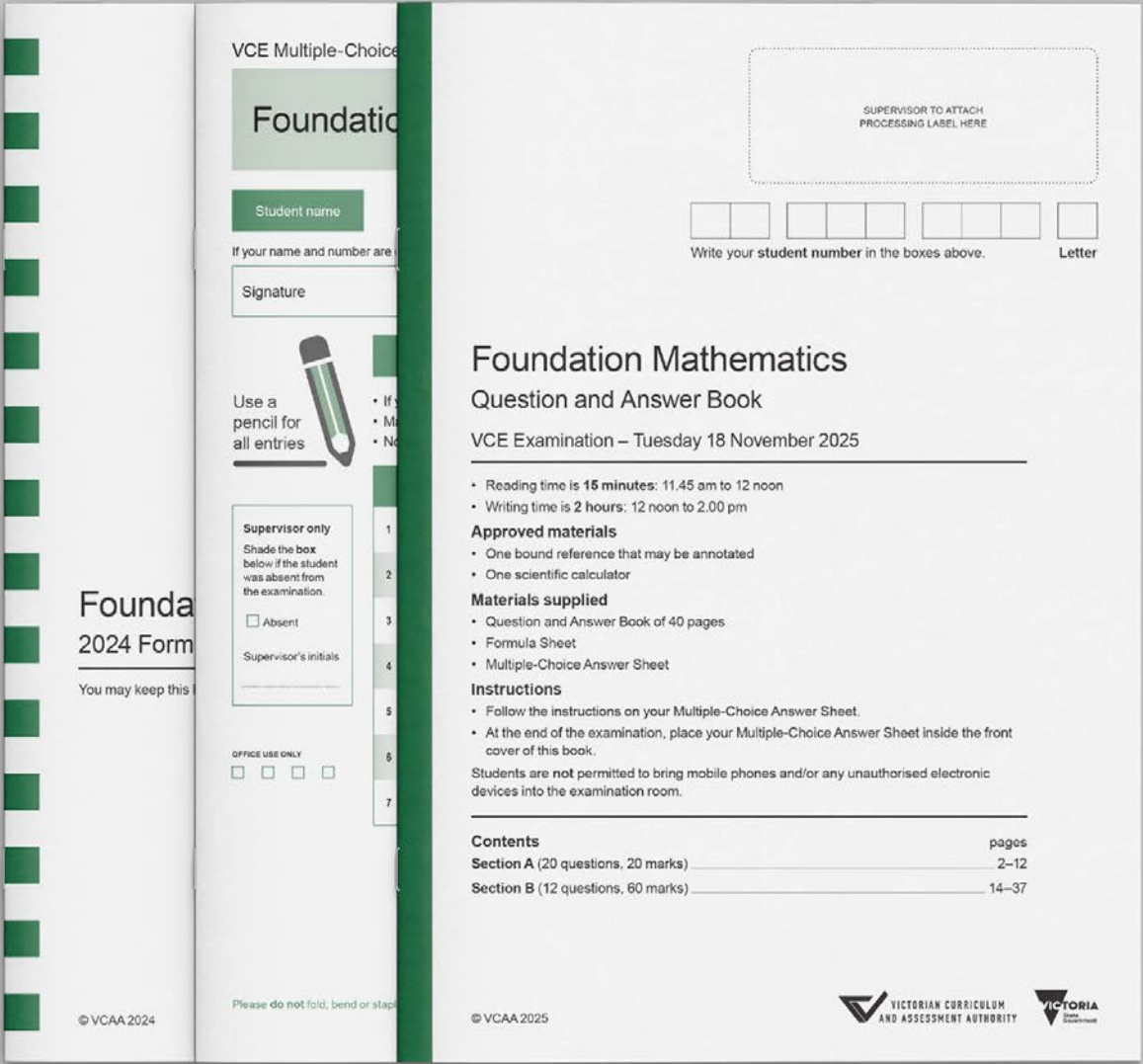


The Constraints

Examination papers must comply with precise scanning and marking requirements, OMR grids, critical clearspace, fixed technical boundaries and colour management. Working within those constraints, the redesign still achieved a considered, balanced layout across every page.



The Visual System



**Role: Senior Designer /
Art Direction (end-to-end)**

Departmental practice guide
addressing linguistic diversity and
multilingual development in early
learning and education settings.

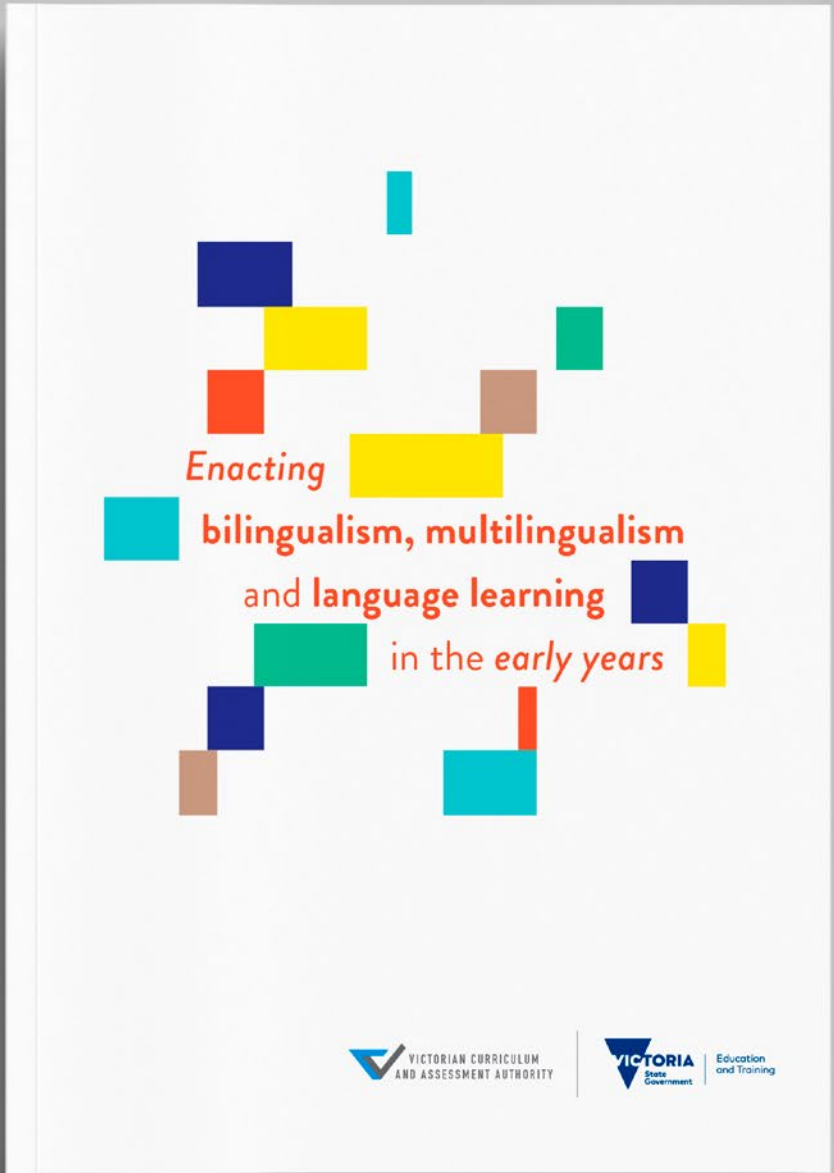
Led design and art direction to
translate complex educational
research into a clear, accessible
resource for educators working
with diverse student communities.
Focused on clarity, inclusivity and
real-world usability.

Key contributions:

- Structured and visualised
complex guidance for
non-specialist audiences
- Balanced accessibility with
departmental requirements
and sensitivities
- Designed for practical use
by educators

Outcome:

A practical, educator-facing resource
supporting inclusive practice across
linguistically diverse settings.





Koorie Languages in Victoria

The vision of *Marrung: Aboriginal Education Plan 2016–2026* is that Victoria will be ‘a state where the rich and thriving culture, knowledge and experience of First Nations peoples are celebrated by all Victorians; where our universal service systems are inclusive, responsive and respectful of Koorie people at every stage of their learning and development journey; and where every Koorie person achieves their potential, succeeds in life, and feels strong in their cultural identity.’

Marrung commits to ‘increasing the number of Koorie Language programs in Victorian kindergartens and schools, by supporting community efforts at language learning through working with the Victorian Aboriginal Education Association Incorporated (VAEAI) and the Victorian Aboriginal Corporation for Languages (VACL), and providing assistance to support Koorie community members to undertake relevant language and teacher training courses.’

VACL has identified 38 different Traditional Owner Language groups in the state of Victoria.

According to VACL, ‘Language is important to Aboriginal people because it is a way for them to express their identity and be proud of where they come from and who they are. If a person knows a word in their language he/she is maintaining a link that has lasted thousands of years, keeping words alive that have been used by their ancestors – language is an ancestral right and it distinguishes something special about Aboriginal people from non-Aboriginal people. Language is a part of culture, and knowledge about culture is a means of empowering people. Language contributes to the wellbeing of Aboriginal communities, strengthens ties between Elders and young people and improves education in general for Indigenous people of all ages.’

The Victorian *Aboriginal Heritage Act 2006* recognises Aboriginal people as the primary guardians, keepers and knowledge-holders of Aboriginal cultural heritage. This includes intangible cultural heritage such as language. At a local level, Registered Aboriginal Parties (RAPs) are the voice of Aboriginal people in the management and protection of Aboriginal cultural heritage in Victoria.



The VEYLDF recognises and respects Aboriginal cultures and their unique place in the heritage and future of Victoria. Learning about and valuing the place of Aboriginal people will enhance all Victorian children’s sense of place in our community. (VEYLDF, p. 4)

Acehnese Acholi Afrikaans Akan Albanian
Assamese AssyrianNeo-Aramaic Auslan Azeri
Basque Bassa Belorussian Bemba Bengali
Burmese Cantonese Catalan Cebuano
Croatian Cypriot Czech Dan Danish Dari
Estonian Ewe Fijian Fijian Hindustani
Frisian Fulfulde Ga Gaelic Georgian
Gio-Dan Greek Gujarati Hakka
Hebrew Hiligaynon Hindi Hiri Motu
Iberian Romance Icelandic Igbo
Iranic Italian Japanese Javanese
Key Word Sign Australia Khmer
Konkani Korean Kpelle Krahn Krio
Letzeburgesch Liberian English Lingala Lithuanian
Lumun Luo Macedo-Romanian Macedonian
Mandaean (Mandaic) Mandarin Mandinka
Min Nan Mon Mongolian Mon-Khmer
Niue Norf'k-Pitkern Norwegian Nuba Moro Nuer
Pashto Persian Pidgin Polish Portuguese
Romany Rotuman Rundi Russian
Shilluk Shona Sindhi Sinhalese
Somali Spanish Spanish Creole Swahili
Tetum Thai Themne Tibetan Tigre Tigrinya
Tulu Turkic Turkish Turkmen Tuvaluan
Vietnamese Welsh Wu Xhosa

Amharic Anuak Arabic Armenian Aromunian
Balinese Balochi Baltic Bari
Bikol Bisaya Bislama Bosnian Bulgarian
Celtic Chaldean Neo-Aramaic Chin Haka Creole
Dhivehi Dinka Dravidian Dutch East Slavic
Filipino Finnish French French Creole
German Gilbertese Hazaraghi
Harari Hausa Hawaiian English
Hmong Hmong-Mien Hungarian Iban
Ilokano Ilonggo Indo-Aryan Indonesian
Kannada Karen Kashmiri
Kikuyu Kinyarwanda Kirundi Kiwai
Kuku Lumun Kurdish Lao Latin Latvian
Loma Lorma Luganda
Madi Malay Malayalam Maltese
Mann Maori Marathi Mauritian Creole
Moro Motu Nauruan Ndebele Nepali
Nyanja Oriya Oromo Pampangan
Portuguese Creole Punjabi Rohingya Romanian
Samoan Scottish Gaelic Serbian Seychelles Creole
Slovak Slovene Solomon Islands Pijin
Swedish Tagalog Tai Tamil Tatar Telugu
Timorese Tok Pisin Tokelauan Tongan Tswana
Ukrainian Urdu Uyghur Uzbek
Yapese Yiddish Yoruba Zomi Zulu

**Role: Senior Designer /
Digital Design (end-to-end)**

Designed an interactive PDF toolkit guiding teams through different stages of project skills development.

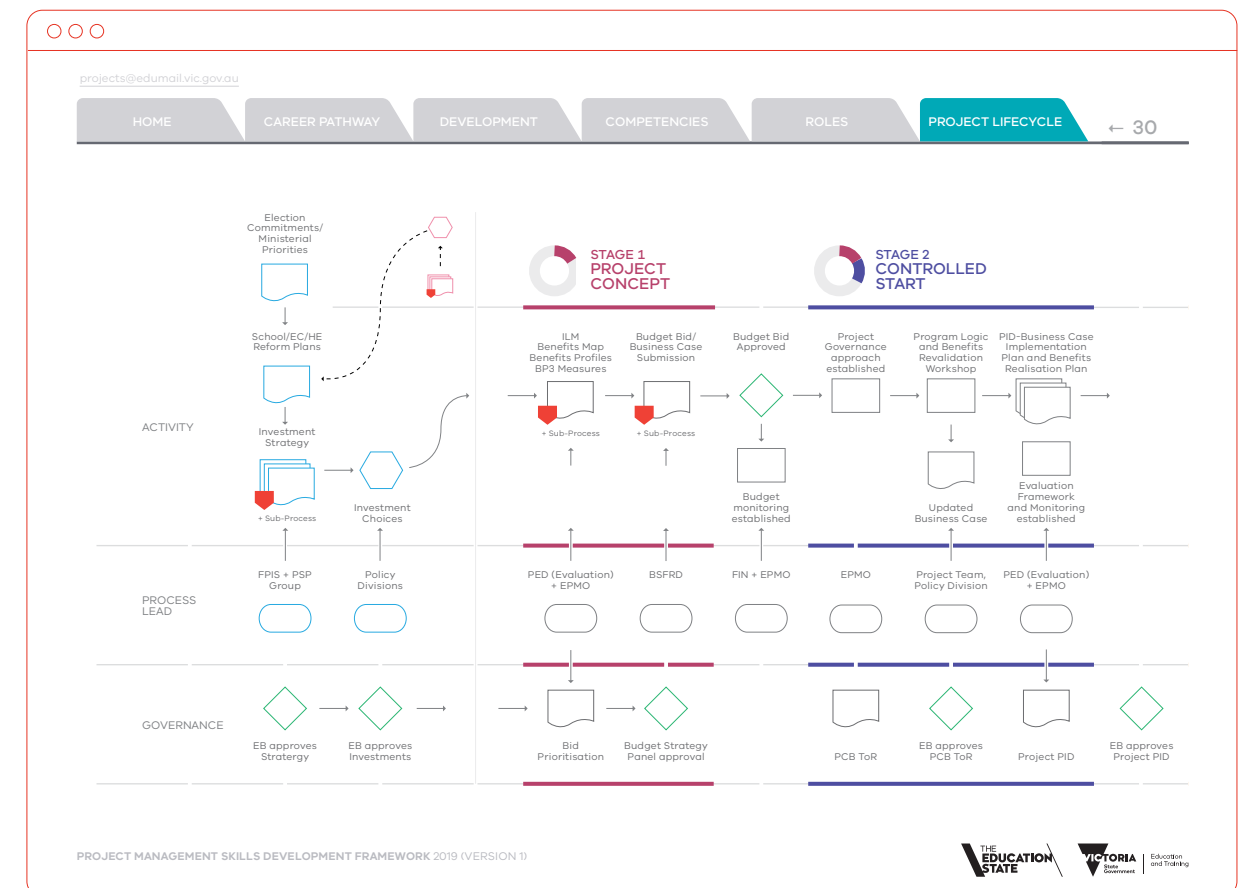
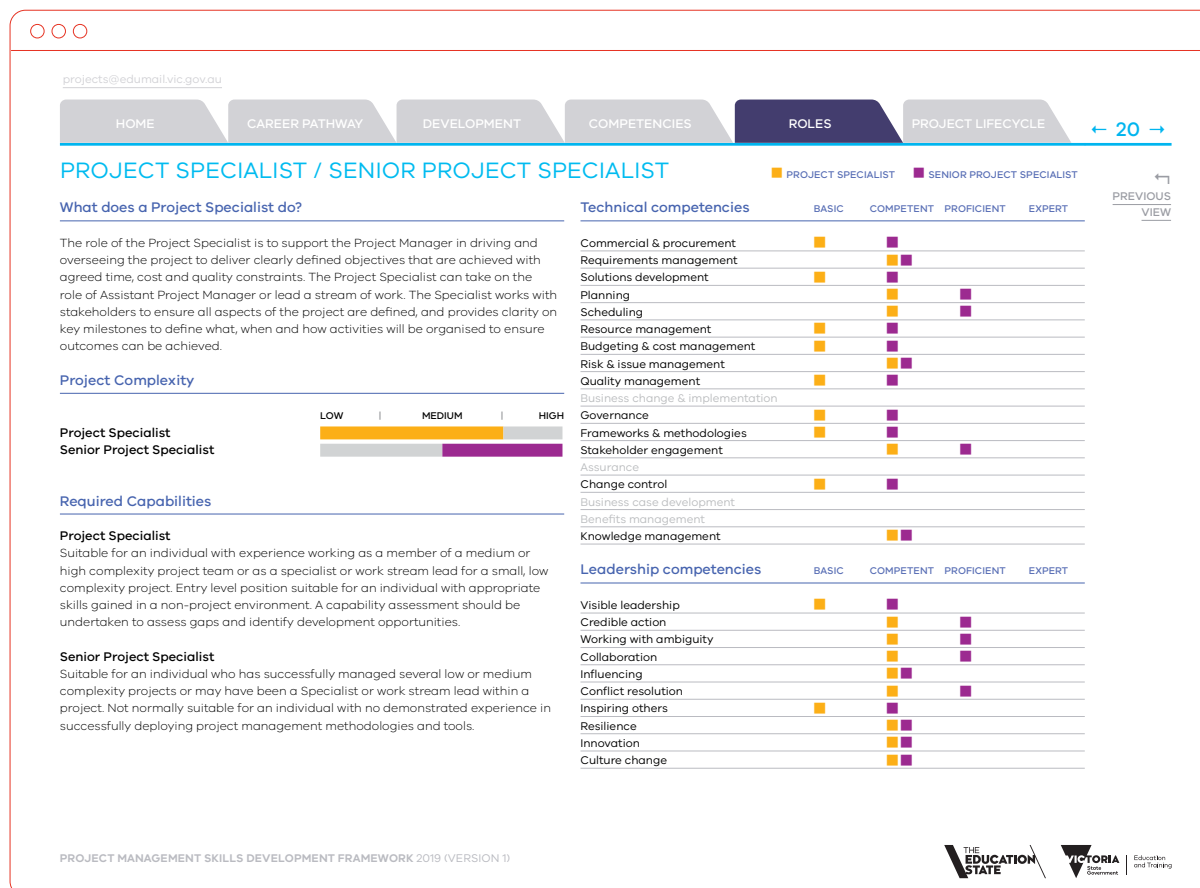
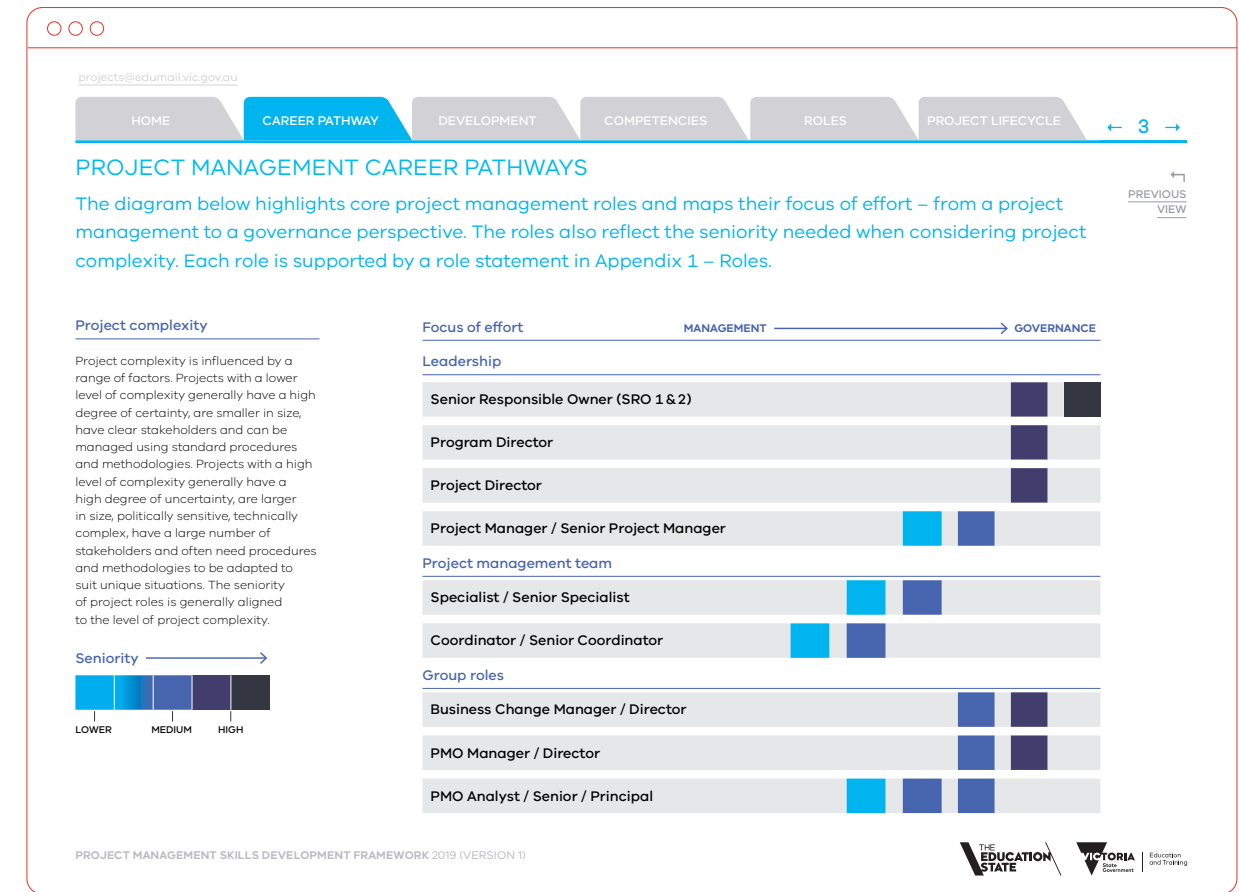
Build a user-driven navigation structure with extensive interactive features, allowing flexible access to relevant guidance rather than a fixed linear path.

Key contributions:

- Designed interaction patterns for self-directed learning
- Improved usability of complex internal guidance
- Extended the handbook system into a practical digital format

Outcome:

A low-friction, flexible resource supporting project capability uplift across the department.



Role: Senior Designer / Art Direction (end-to-end)

Led design and art direction for a series of internal project management handbooks supporting consistent project delivery across the department.

Worked closely with subject matter experts to translate project management frameworks into clear, accessible resources for teams with varied experience levels.

Key contributions:

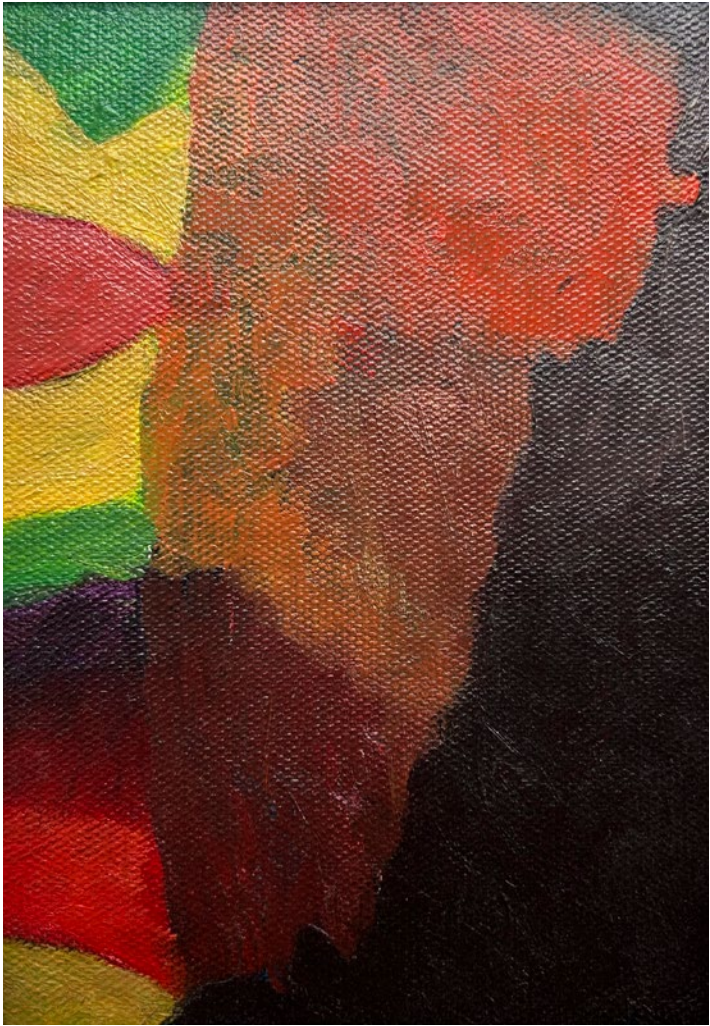
- Structured complex operational guidance into usable handbooks
- Designed for clarity, accessibility, and adoption across diverse teams
- Supported consistent project delivery at scale



Derrick M. Barry
Tel: 0422 480 610
dezz.barry@proton.me

[↑ Contents](#)

Personal work. Oil on canvas.



Dark mass acid yellow green.